

1.2 TACTICS IN FUTSAL

1.2.1 The objectives of tactics

Tactics are determined by the objectives in the game, which differ for each of the two key processes: attack and defence. A team's objectives are to score in the opposition goal and prevent the opposition from scoring in their goal. The objectives of each process are explained in more detail below:

The objectives of attack

The key objectives for the attack are founded on what can be termed as 'the general principles of attacking play' (Bayer, 1986). These are as follows:

1. **To retain possession of the ball:** the first key objective after winning possession must be to keep the ball.
2. **To advance with the ball towards the opposition goal (advance in play):** the next logical objective is to advance with the ball towards the opposition goal and get into a position to finish on goal.
3. **To finish on goal/score a goal:** the ultimate objective of the attacking move is to create goal-scoring opportunities and convert them into goals.

The objectives of defence

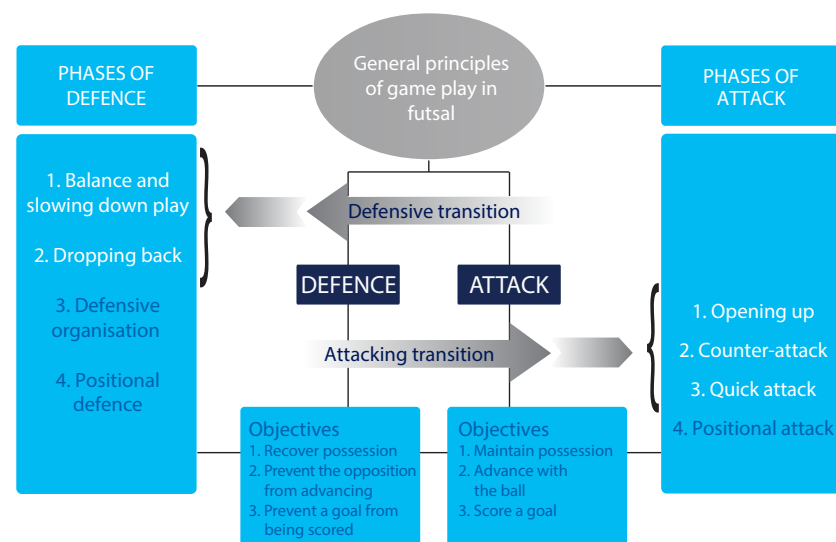
As with attacking play, the three objectives in terms of defending are based on 'the general principles of defensive play' (Bayer, 1986). These are as follows:

1. **To regain possession of the ball:** the key objective when defending is to regain possession of the ball and switch the team's play from defence to attack.

Once a team has recovered possession, all defensive objectives have been met (when you regain the ball you are implicitly preventing your rival from advancing and scoring) and it can switch the focus to attacking objectives. The recovery of the ball should therefore be considered the fundamental goal of the defensive process.

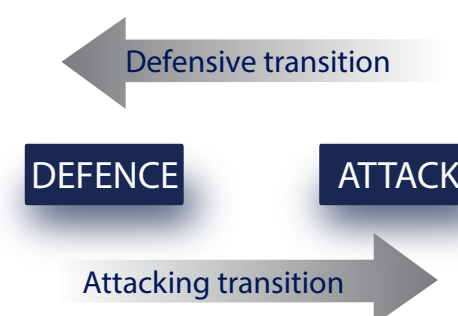
2. **To prevent the opposition from advancing or to control their advance:** the objective is to make it difficult for the opposition to advance. If possession cannot be retrieved, then the minimum aim should be to keep the opposition away from the danger zone.
3. **To prevent the opposition from finishing on goal/scoring or to restrict their opportunities to do so:** the defence's ultimate objective is to prevent the opposition team from scoring a goal.

1.2.2 Tactical structure of futsal



1.2.3 The game cycle

In this section, we are going to look at the game cycle, which is based on the periods of attack and defence – in other words, those occasions when a team has possession and those when it does not. The switch from attack to defence is known as the defensive transition, while the switch from defence to attack is referred to as the attacking transition. These are cyclical processes that are repeated throughout a match.



In a positional attack, a team attacks against an already organised defence, whereas an attacking transition occurs when a team regains the ball and tries to attack before the opposition's defence is in position and has reorganised itself, attempting to benefit from a numerical or positional advantage in order to create an opportunity to finish on goal quickly.

In a positional defence, all of the defenders are organised and in position, whereas in a defensive transition, all defensive actions and intentions are executed when the ball has been lost and up to the point when the defending team has reorganised itself or managed to prevent or break up the opposition's attacking transition.

1.2.4 Attacking tactics

Attacking tactics are the individual or group elements that a team's players execute when in possession of the ball, attempting to overcome the opposition and achieve the objectives of the attack. In other words, they are the actions that are executed within the different phases of attack (opening up, counter-attack, quick attack and positional attack).

Phases of attack

4. Positional attack
3. Quick attack
2. Counter-attack
1. Opening up



Opening up: an action in which the intention is to attack and which involves a swift regrouping after possession is regained, preventing the opposition defence from dropping back and regaining their shape, and thereby creating a numerical advantage or the defensive disorganisation that is required to facilitate a successful counter-attack. Failing this, possession of the ball can be maintained with a view to launching a quick attack or a positional attack.

Counter-attack: an attacking play where a team advances on the opposition's goal quickly before the opposition team's four outfield players are in position to defend. The opposition does not have all of their players positioned behind the ball, and therefore the defensive unit is not complete.

Quick attack: the last phase of the attacking transition, in which the intention is still to attack quickly. Even though the four players from the defending team are behind the ball, they are not set up to defend, therefore the attacking team can gain a positional advantage before their opponents manage to organise themselves defensively.

Positional attack: an attacking play executed against a defence which is already in position and organised and which cannot be caught off guard by a counter-attack or quick attack. Generally, this approach involves organising and coordinating the players in an attacking play, with the aim of occupying areas of the court effectively, controlling possession of the ball and finishing on goal.